

Your vet bill beat inflation. Or did it?

Prices of veterinary and other pet services versus all-items inflation, January 2021 to December 2025, in 15 European countries and the United States.

+71%

vet services, Poland.
Headline was +40%.

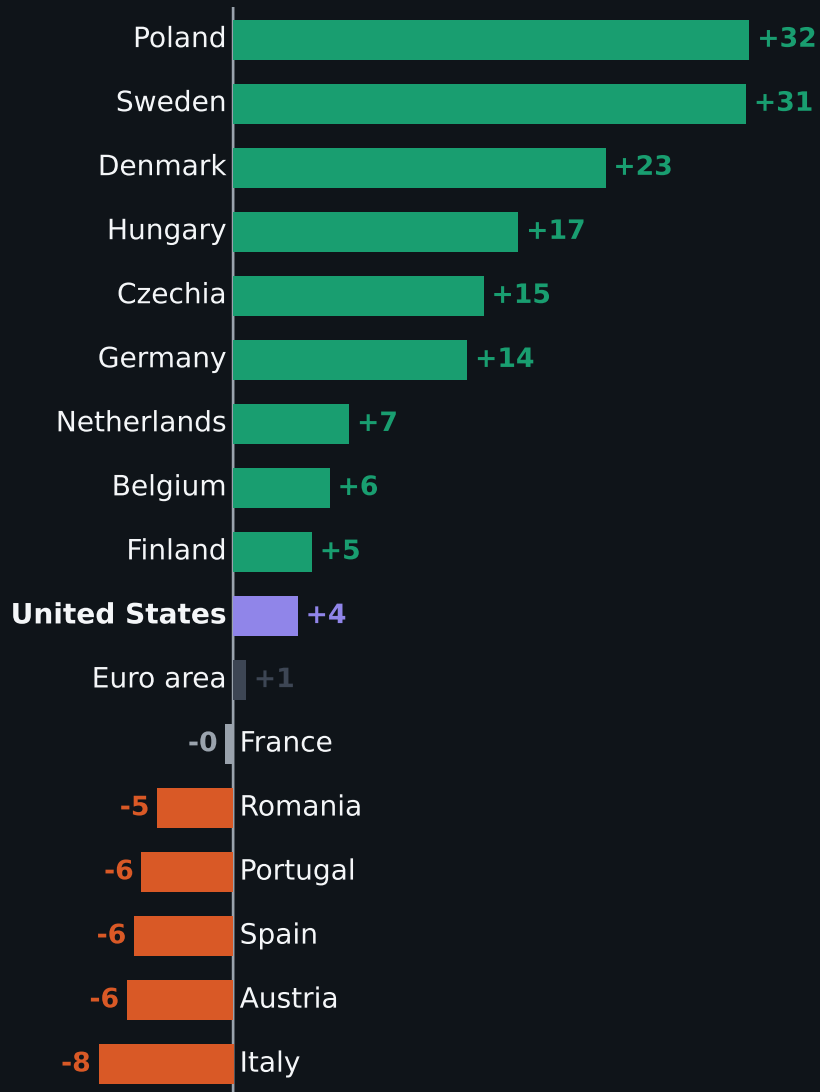
+14%

vet services, Italy.
Headline was +22%.

Same period, same measure. In the North and East vet prices ran far ahead of inflation; across the South they fell behind it. The split is the story — slides inside.

Consumer prices — what pet owners pay. Not farm animal health costs. Sources and scope on the final slide.

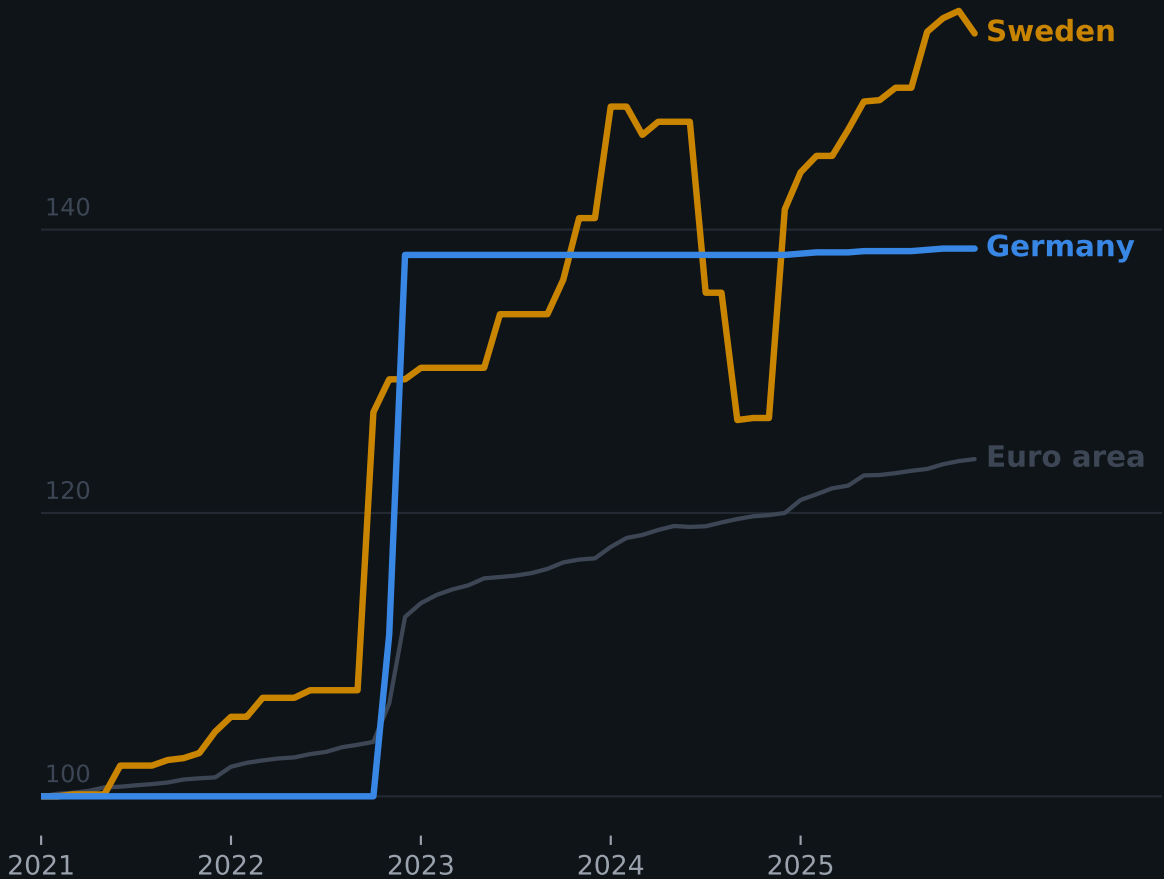
North and East: far ahead. South: behind inflation.



Bar = vet-services inflation minus all-items inflation, in percentage points, per country, Jan 2021 → Dec 2025. Purple = United States.

HOW IT HAPPENED

Not a drift. Two jumps.



Germany: +24% in a single month (Dec 2022), when the national veterinary fee schedule (GOT) was revised for the first time since 1999. Sweden: +18% in Oct 2022, as consolidated clinic chains repriced.

Vet-services price index per market, Jan 2021 = 100, to Dec 2025.
Regulated fee schedules move in steps — and reset the level for good.

The loudest story is mid-table.



US pet services incl. veterinary: +47% over the decade, against +39% for all items — ahead, but no Poland. Since Jan 2021 the gap is +4 points: less than Denmark's, Germany's or Sweden's.

BLS CPI, US city average, not seasonally adjusted, Jan 2015 = 100.
Same basket definition as the European series.

Three readers, three moves.

Pet owners — budget by geography.

In Poland, Sweden, Denmark or Germany, index your pet budget to vet prices, not to headline inflation — the gap has compounded to 14–32 points in five years.

Insurers & clinic operators — watch the fee schedules.

The big single moves were regulatory (Germany's GOT) or structural (Nordic chain consolidation). The next scheduled fee revision is the repricing event — not CPI drift.

Analysts — don't import the US narrative.

Vet inflation is a country story, not a global one. Italy, Spain, Portugal and Austria sit below headline inflation. Check the local index before repeating the meme.

What would change this: a fee-schedule revision in a below-headline country, or a Southern-European consolidation wave, flips its lane.

WHAT THIS COVERS

Scope and sources.

MEASURE

Consumer price indices: what households pay for veterinary and other pet services, versus all-items inflation. This is not farm animal health spending.

WINDOW

Jan 2021 → Dec 2025 on every comparison, all markets.
The decade slide (US) is Jan 2015 → Dec 2025 and says so.

EXCLUDED

Ireland — its vet-services index stops at Dec 2023.
Türkiye — publishes only all-items HICP to Eurostat;
a Turkish vet series would need TÜİK data.

KNOWN STEPS

Germany +24% (Dec 2022, GOT fee-schedule revision) and
Sweden +18% (Oct 2022) are real repricings, not data
breaks. No methodology break spans the window.

SOURCES

Eurostat prc_hicp_midx, monthly, 2015=100: CP0935 veterinary and other services for pets; CP00 all items; 1996→2025.
BLS CPI via FRED, monthly, NSA: CUUR0000SS62031 pet services incl. veterinary (1997→2026); CPIAUCNS all items.
Data files: data/vet-cpi-eu.json · data/vet-cpi-us.json,
cut 11 Aug 2026 — every figure recomputable from them.

Personal analysis of public statistics. Views my own.